



THE WILLISTON MUSIC INTENSIVE

Building Community & Stewarding
Talent Across Western North Dakota

www.willistonmusic.com



Alma Cook is a pop singer-songwriter who found her creative roots living in Chicago and LA. After years of coming back and forth to Williston for work, she fell in love with North Dakota and decided to put down roots—just in time to make state and national headlines for her music video, “**5000 Candles**,” which showcased the faces and stories of her friends in the Bakken.



Alma performing for Continental founder Harold Hamm and Gov. Doug Burgum

From the Founder

Culture is quality of life. Thank you for investing in ours.

I believe in a radical, out-of-left-field idea: that **the Bakken could become a regional music destination.**

Since 2022, the Williston Music Intensive (WMI) has been witness to musicians and singers of all ages, genres, and walks of life resolving to come under one roof and level up. Mastery takes time, but our community has grown leaps and bounds and built unlikely friendships (complete with lots of new group chats!) with every passing year.

Just like the wildcatters who bet on the Bakken before the rest of the world caught on, our local music scene is scrappy, resourceful, and sitting on something real. By connecting our local artists to each other and giving them trainings and regular chances to perform, WMI is challenging Bakken talent to expand their horizons of musical excellence. I hope you'll join us.

Sincerely,
Alma Cook

A handwritten signature in brown ink, appearing to read 'Alma Cook'.



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Learn more at willistonmusic.com



Mission

We are here to **build a vibrant music scene in the Bakken**, giving pop/rock musicians a place to build community, grow their talents, and perform.

Goals

- Offer **world-class trainings** for pop/rock singers and instrumentalists.
- Bring the region's disparate **musical communities**—from churches, restaurants/bars, and schools—under one roof.
- Create high-quality **concert experiences** and get more musicians on local stages.
- Get young people off their phones and help them build **intergenerational relationships**.

Programming

Pop/Rock Workshops

Multi-day trainings where singers and instrumentalists **learn the fundamentals of playing in a band**. Through group jams, panels, and breakout sessions, attendees build relationships with one another and expand their musical toolkits—all in preparation for a free community concert.

Youth Open Mics

A safe place for creatives to **take risks, make mistakes, and get loud**. Each month, all ages and experience levels are invited to perform whatever music, poetry, or comedy that they're working on—with no pressure and no judgment. One "featured artist" is chosen to play for 30 minutes at the top of each night, so the open mic also functions as an **entry-level gig** for many of our performers as they build their repertoire.

Musician Meetups

Casual meetups for local musicians and singers of all ages to mingle and build connections.



Testimonials

I honestly did not expect to learn this much [at the workshop]. Even if you don't have much of a background, the amount of things you could learn from just being here for a few days is truly amazing.

Daphne Tredwell, 14



I came here not knowing anyone, & I've made at least 20 new friends. The

Williston Music Intensive is a great program—not only for getting to play music, learn new songs, and meet new people, but getting to express yourself on your instrument.

Kris Clark, 42

It was fun to feel connected and be a part of something bigger than yourself! I definitely learned a few more technical things for singing, and I'm excited to put back that into my craft.

Rachel Wallace, 26

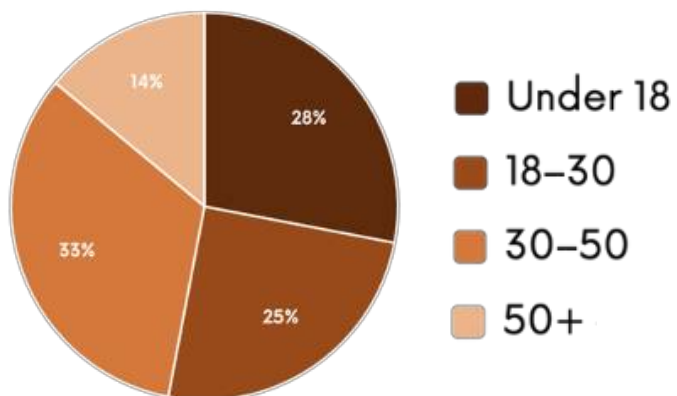


Impact

Our workshops have put **122 adults and teens** on stage from Williston, Watford, Dickinson, Tioga, and Fairview. Meanwhile, our monthly open mics draw **50+ attendees** per event.

Generational Balance

The age distribution of our workshops reflects a firm belief in **cross-generational** collaboration. To grow in maturity, **teens and children** need the opportunity to work side-by-side with adults—and **adults**, who often feel it's too late to try new things, need a reminder that they're never too old to pick up a guitar or a microphone.



Gender Balance

The gender distribution of our workshops has been evenly balanced (53% female, 47% male), reflecting a space where men/women both feel welcome.



Past, Present, & Future

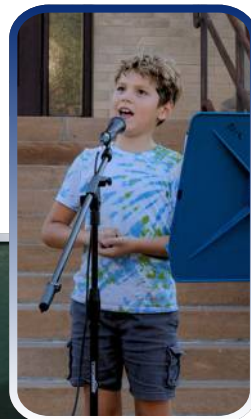
THE
WILLISTON
MUSIC
INTENSIVE

OCT. 7-9, 2022



First pop/rock workshop

Monthly
Spotlight open
mic begins



Spotlight

APR. 29, 2024

JUNE 12-14, 2024



Second pop/rock workshop



Third pop/rock workshop
(exclusively for singers)

Fourth pop/rock workshop
(full-band)



Awarded North
Dakota Council on the
Arts project grant

AUG. 15,
2025

JULY 20–24, 2026

NOV. 14,
2024

OCT. 6–10, 2025

First musicians
networking meetup

UP NEXT:

- Running **live music stages** at existing community events to give our musicians more real-world experience
- Smaller, **premium workshops** culminating in real-life gigs
- Expanding to **neighboring cities** with pilot programs



Instructors

Every Williston Music Intensive instructor is a real, working musician. We invite industry heavy-hitters from Los Angeles, Chicago, Atlanta, and New York City to teach our region's up-and-comers: musicians whose expertise spans **major-label pop, gospel, country, rock, Broadway, and R&B.** Students get direct insight into how the pros build sustainable careers across genres and settings.

We also bring in Williston-area mentors for panels and bonus sessions. These are artists who make music in our very own churches, restaurants/bars, and classical ensembles, offering an on-the-ground view of Western Dakota's creative landscape.

Core Instructors



Alma Cook, Williston-based singer-songwriter & multi-instrumentalist



Chris Thigpen, bassist/drummer for Hamilton, Charlie Puth, Meghan Trainor



Emily Black-Driscoll, Williston-based piano/voice instructor & choir director



Leonard Maddox, drummer for gospel artists Darius Brooks, Jonathan McReynolds



Alec Lehrman, guitarist for Gavin DeGraw, Kanye West, Chainsmokers, BTS, Aloe Blacc



Joshua Foster, drummer for Mariah Carey, Snoop Dogg, Erykah Badu

Bonus Panelists/Speakers



Emily Erickson, Life Church worship pastor



Brandon Foster, guitarist & singer



Carmen Delaney, flute/guitar instructor



Seth Babbitt, singer-songwriter

Friends & Partners



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PRESERVE HISTORY • PROMOTE ART • ENHANCE COMMUNITY

Media Mentions

We work hard to honor sponsors with high-quality media mentions and logo placements. Since 2022, here are some of the outlets who have covered our events:



BakkenLiving



Minot Daily News

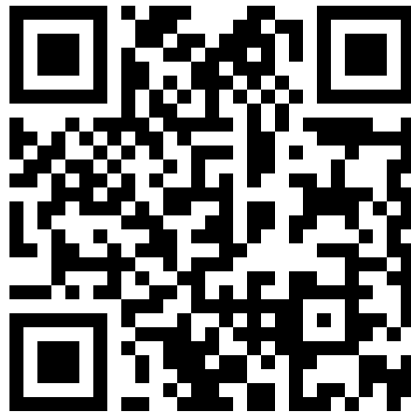




How to Give

Ready to invest in Williston's music community?

Whether you're looking to make a quick donation or become an official event sponsor, scan the QR code below or visit **sponsor.willistonmusic.com**.



sponsor.willistonmusic.com

Contact

Text/call: (608) 320-4345

Email: team@willistonmusic.com

Mailing address:

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Williston, ND 58801

Website: willistonmusic.com

Facebook:

fb.com/willistonmusic

Instagram:

[@willistonmusic](https://www.instagram.com/willistonmusic)





Culture is quality of life.

Thank you for investing in the Williston Music Intensive's workshops, open mics, concerts, & community meetups.

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GIVE NOW!

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